

JusticeLink: Pro-Bono Legal Matchmaking & Rights Education Portal

The Core Concept: Low-income individuals frequently face severe legal crises, like unlawful eviction or workplace exploitation, without the financial means to hire representation or the knowledge to defend themselves. Meanwhile, lawyers who want to do pro-bono work lack a centralized way to find clients in need. JusticeLink bridges this "justice gap" by acting as a secure triage and matching engine that connects marginalized citizens directly with volunteer legal professionals.

System Scope: A mobile application for the public and a secure web dashboard for volunteer lawyers and legal aid clinics. Users complete a "Smart Legal Triage" questionnaire on the app to categorize their issue and are digitally matched with a lawyer with the right expertise. The app also features a localized, plain-language "Know Your Rights" library and document generator for self-advocacy.

What it excludes: Acting as an official court filing system, guaranteeing guaranteed legal representation for every single user, or handling any financial transactions, billing, or retainers (it strictly facilitates pro-bono connections and dispenses educational resources).

Objectives:

- Streamline access to legal aid by replacing fragmented, localized outreach efforts with a centralized, smart-matching platform that instantly connects vulnerable users to the right legal expertise.
- Empower citizens to handle minor disputes independently and confidently through automated, easy-to-understand legal document templates and accessible rights education.
- Provide legal professionals with an automated tracking dashboard to log their pro-bono hours for bar association compliance, while giving clinics analytics on prevalent community legal issues. (SDGs: 16 - Peace, Justice, and Strong Institutions, 10 - Reduced Inequalities).